

Beyond Social: services and running costs

Prepared 21 July 2026. Every figure below was checked against the vendor's current public pricing on that date. Prices change; re-check before committing budget. Figures are USD and exclude tax.

Costs are split into three columns:

- **Build:** what you need while the product is being built and tested.
- **Launch:** a small paying user base, roughly 100 active users.
- **Scale:** roughly 1,000 active users.

Usage-based lines are estimates and are marked as such. Fixed subscription lines are exact.

1. Domain and identity

Item	Why it is needed	Plan	Build	Launch	Scale
Domain name (.com)	Public address, email sender identity, Apple Pay domain verification	Registrar of choice	~\$12/yr	~\$12/yr	~\$12/yr
TLS certificate	HTTPS	Included free by Vercel	\$0	\$0	\$0

Note: Apple Pay through Stripe requires domain verification but carries no separate Apple fee. An Apple Developer account is not required.

2. Hosting and infrastructure

Item	Why it is needed	Plan	Build	Launch	Scale
Vercel	Hosts the Next.js web app	Hobby, then Pro	\$0	\$20/mo per developer	\$20/mo per developer, plus overages
Worker host	The BullMQ worker is a long-running process and cannot run on serverless functions	Railway Hobby or Render Starter	\$0 to \$5/mo	~\$5 to \$7/mo	~\$25/mo
Redis	BullMQ job queue backing store	Upstash free, then pay as you go or fixed	\$0	~\$0 to \$10/mo	~\$20/mo fixed (1 GB)

Vercel Pro includes 1 TB bandwidth, 10 million edge requests and a \$20 flexible spend credit. Viewer seats are free, so only active developers are billed. Upstash pay as you go is \$0.20 per 100,000 commands plus \$0.25 per GB-month above the first free GB, with no bandwidth charge; fixed plans start at \$10/mo for 250 MB and \$20/mo for 1 GB.

3. Database, auth and storage

Item	Why it is needed	Plan	Build	Launch	Scale
Supabase	Postgres, authentication, and object storage for generated video	Free, then Pro	\$0	\$25/mo	\$25/mo plus usage

Supabase Pro is \$25/mo and includes a \$10 monthly compute credit. Be aware that compute, egress and per-project charges are billed on top, and that video storage and delivery is the single most likely line to exceed its base price. Model egress specifically before launch.

4. AI services

This is the largest and least predictable category. It is also the one that scales directly with usage rather than with user count.

Item	Why it is needed	Pricing basis	Notes
Higgsfield (WAN 2.6)	Generates the video from the user's photos	Subscription with credits: Starter \$15/mo (200 credits), Plus \$39/mo (1,000 credits), Ultra \$99/mo (3,000 credits), billed annually	Credit cost per generation varies by model. This is a consumer subscription, not a per-seat API contract. See the risk note below.
Claude (Anthropic)	Writes the script and drives the conversational interface	Per million tokens. Opus 4.8: \$5 in, \$25 out. Sonnet 5: \$3 in, \$15 out (introductory \$2 in, \$10 out through 31 Aug 2026). Haiku 4.5: \$1 in, \$5 out	Script generation is a short-output task. Sonnet or Haiku are the cost-appropriate tiers here; reserve Opus for harder reasoning.
Firecrawl	Refreshes the trend feed on a schedule	Free 1,000 credits/mo, Hobby ~\$16/mo (3,000 credits), Standard ~\$83/mo (100,000 credits)	Credits do not roll over. Trend refresh is a scheduled job, so usage is predictable and easy to cap.

Estimated AI cost per finished video

A single video costs roughly: one script generation (a few thousand tokens, so fractions of a cent on Sonnet or Haiku) plus one video generation (the dominant cost, set by Higgsfield credits). In practice the script is a rounding error and the video generation is effectively your entire per-unit cost. Your gross margin is therefore decided almost entirely by the Higgsfield credit price per generation and by how many credits a WAN 2.6 render consumes.

Risk to resolve before launch: Higgsfield's published pricing is a consumer subscription tied to an account, not a metered commercial API with per-generation billing and resale rights. Reselling generations to your own paying users under a consumer plan may not be permitted, and the credit pools will not scale to 1,000 users. Contact Higgsfield for commercial or API terms and get a per-generation price in writing. Do not build a subscription pricing model on top of an unconfirmed unit cost.

5. Publishing

Item	Why it is needed	Plan	Build	Launch	Scale
Upload-post	One API to publish and schedule to TikTok, Instagram, Facebook and YouTube Shorts, and to hold the OAuth and platform compliance	Free tier 10 uploads/mo, paid from \$16/mo billed annually with unlimited uploads and full API access	\$0	\$16/mo	\$16/mo, confirm fair-use limits

Confirm with Upload-post whether "unlimited" holds when publishing on behalf of many end users rather than a single account, and whether per-customer social account connections are supported on that plan.

6. Payments

Item	Why it is needed	Pricing basis
Stripe	Subscriptions, checkout, Apple Pay	2.9% + \$0.30 per successful US card charge. International cards add 1.5%, currency conversion adds 1%, disputes \$15 each. No monthly fee on the standard plan.

At a \$29/mo subscription price, Stripe takes roughly \$1.14 per charge, or about 3.9% of revenue. Stripe Billing, if used for subscription management, is charged on top of the base transaction fee.

7. Supporting services

These are not in the architecture document but are needed in practice.

Item	Why it is needed	Typical cost
Transactional email	Password resets, OTP verification, publish notifications. The auth flow already exists and will not work without it.	Free tier is usually sufficient at launch, roughly \$20/mo beyond that
Error monitoring	A background worker that fails silently will lose paid user videos	Free tier at launch, roughly \$26/mo beyond that
Analytics	Understanding activation and churn	\$0 to \$20/mo

8. Totals

Fixed monthly cost, excluding all usage-based AI generation and excluding Stripe's percentage:

	Build	Launch (~100 users)	Scale (~1,000 users)
Hosting and infrastructure	\$0 to \$5	~\$32	~\$65
Database and storage	\$0	\$25	\$25 plus usage
Publishing	\$0	\$16	\$16

	Build	Launch (~100 users)	Scale (~1,000 users)
Trends (Firecrawl)	\$0	~\$16	~\$83
Supporting services	\$0	\$0	~\$46
Fixed subtotal	\$0 to \$5	~\$89/mo	~\$235/mo

On top of the subtotal:

- **Video generation:** unknown until Higgsfield commercial terms are agreed. This will be the largest line at scale by a wide margin.
- **Script generation:** small. At a few thousand tokens per script on Sonnet or Haiku, this stays in the low tens of dollars per month even at 1,000 users.
- **Stripe:** about 3.9% of revenue at a \$29 price point.
- **Vercel and Supabase overages:** driven by video egress. Model this.

9. What to settle next

1. **Get a per-generation price from Higgsfield in writing**, with commercial resale terms. Nothing else in the model can be finalised until this is known, because it sets both unit cost and the minimum viable subscription price.
2. **Confirm Upload-post's multi-tenant terms**, specifically publishing on behalf of many end users.
3. **Model video storage and egress on Supabase.** Short-form video is small per file but delivery adds up, and it is billed separately from the \$25 base.
4. **Decide the Claude tier per task.** Script generation does not need the most expensive model; the conversational refinement loop may.
5. **Set a credit quota per plan** that is grounded in the real per-generation cost, not a guess.

Sources

Supabase, Vercel, Upstash, Firecrawl, Higgsfield, Upload-post and Stripe public pricing pages and pricing summaries, all retrieved 21 July 2026. Claude model pricing from Anthropic's platform documentation, retrieved 21 July 2026.